Triple Triad

Instruction Manual

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"In a world where cards hold power, every ma

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I. Welcome to Triple Triad

Welcome to **Triple Triad**, the legendary card game from the world of Final Fantasy VIII. In this world, cards are more than collectibles — they are instruments of power, prestige, and strategy.

As a student of **Balamb Garden**, you will travel across six distinct regions, challenging NPCs, conquering dungeons, winning tournaments, and building the ultimate card collection. Each region plays by its own rules, and mastering them all is the key to becoming the Champion of Triple Triad.

What Awaits You

- **110 unique cards** across 10 power levels, from common creatures to legendary heroes
- **18 story chapters** spanning an epic campaign inspired by Final Fantasy VIII
- **6 regions** with unique rule sets that transform how the game is played
- **30+ locations** including towns, dungeons, and secret areas
- **150+ NPCs** to challenge, each with their own decks and personalities
- **8 special rules** that stack and combine in endlessly varied ways
- **Bluetooth multiplayer** for local matches with friends

Getting Started

When you first launch Triple Triad, you will begin in **Balamb**, the starting region. Your initial deck contains five Level 1 cards — humble but effective for your first duels. Seek out the NPCs in Balamb Garden and Balamb Town to hone your skills.

> TIP
>
> Balamb uses the **Open** rule, which lets you see your opponent's hand. Use this to plan your placements carefully before venturing to tougher regions.

2. How to Play

The Game Board

Triple Triad is played on a **3×3 grid**. Two players take turns placing cards from their hand of five onto the board. When all nine spaces are filled, the player who controls more cards wins.

Anatomy of a Card

Every card has four numerical values representing its power on each edge:

```
        [Top]
[Left]   [Right]
     [Bottom]
```

Values range from **1** (weakest) to **A** (10, strongest). Higher-level cards tend to have higher values, but even a Level 1 card with a strong edge can surprise a careless opponent.

Some cards also have an **element** — Fire, Ice, Lightning, Earth, Water, Wind, Poison, or Holy. Elements matter when the Elemental rule is in play.

Capturing Cards

When you place a card on the board, compare its edge values against any adjacent opponent cards:

• If your card's **touching value is higher** than the opponent's touching value, you **capture** their card — it flips to your colour.
• If the values are equal or your value is lower, nothing happens on that edge.

A single placement can capture multiple adjacent cards if your values are higher on multiple edges.

> TIP

> Place cards with low values against the board edges where there are no opponents to attack. Save your strong edges for capturing!

Scoring & Winning

At the end of the game, count the cards you control on the board plus any remaining in your hand:

- **More cards = victory.** A typical winning score is 6–4 or better.
- **5–5 is a draw** (unless Sudden Death is active).
- The player who goes **second** has the last placement, which can be decisive.

Turn Order

Each game consists of 9 placements (filling all board spaces). The first player places 5 cards; the second player places 4 cards but keeps 1 in hand, which counts toward their score. Who goes first is determined randomly.

3. Special Rules

Each region of the world has its own set of special rules that fundamentally change how the game is played. Mastering these rules is essential for your journey.

Open

Both players can see each other's cards face-up throughout the match. This removes the element of surprise and rewards pure strategic thinking.

Found in: Balamb

Same

When you place a card and **two or more** of its edges have the **same value** as the touching edges of adjacent cards, all matching cards are captured — regardless of which value is higher.

Example: You place a card with Right=5 and Bottom=3. The card to the right has Left=5, and the card below has Top=3. Both edges match → both opponent cards are captured.

Found in: Galbadia, Centra

Same Wall

An extension of Same: the edges of the board are treated as having a value of **A (10)**. This means a card placed in a corner with two A-edges touching the walls can trigger Same with just one matching adjacent card.

Found in: Esthar

Plus

When you place a card and **two or more** pairs of touching edges have the **same sum**, all cards involved are captured.

Example: Your card has Right=3 and Bottom=7. The card to the right has Left=5 (sum: 3+5=8), and the card below has Top=1 (sum: 7+1=8). Both sums are 8 → both captured.

Found in: Trabia, Centra

Combo

When cards are captured via Same or Plus, those newly captured cards then check their **other edges** using the basic capture rule. If they can flip additional cards, they do — creating a chain reaction.

Combo can lead to devastating cascades that flip the entire board in a single turn.

Found in: Centra

> WARNING
>
> Centra combines Same + Plus + Combo. A single careless placement can lose you the entire game in a chain reaction. Think several moves ahead!

Elemental

When active, **1–3 random board spaces** are assigned random elements. If a card placed on an elemental space **matches** the element, all its values receive **+1** (max A). If the elements **don't match**, all values receive **−1** (min 1).

Found in: Fisherman's Horizon, Esthar

Random

Your hand of 5 cards is chosen **randomly** from your entire deck rather than letting you select them. Build a strong overall collection to reduce the risk of a weak hand.

Found in: Trabia, Esthar

Sudden Death

If the game ends in a **draw (5–5)**, a new round begins. Each player's hand is reshuffled from the cards they controlled at the end of the previous round. Play continues until someone wins.

Found in: Fisherman's Horizon

4. TRADE RULES

After each match, cards may change hands based on the region's trade rule. Understanding trade rules is crucial — a single loss in Esthar could cost you your entire hand.

RULE	EFFECT	REGION
One	Winner selects **1 card** from the loser's captured cards	Balamb, Galbadia
Diff	Winner takes cards equal to the **score difference** (e.g., 7–3 = 4 cards)	FH, Trabia
Direct	Each player **keeps the cards they captured** during the match	Centra
All	Winner takes the loser's **entire hand**	Esthar
Friendly	**No cards exchanged** (used in multiplayer and repeatable duels)	Multiplayer

> WARNING
>
> The **All** rule in Esthar is extremely punishing. Never bring your rarest cards to Esthar unless you are confident in your ability to win. Consider using expendable cards until you have mastered the region's rule set.

5. The World of Triple Triad

The world is divided into **six regions**, each with its own culture, challenges, and card game rules. New regions unlock as you progress through the story.

Balamb

Home to Balamb Garden and the coastal town of Dollet. The **Open** rule lets you see your opponent's hand — a fair start for new players.
Rules: Open • Trade: One • Available from start

Galbadia

The militaristic continent. The **Same** rule makes positioning crucial — one wrong move and your cards get chain-captured.
Rules: Same • Trade: One • Unlocks: Chapter 3

Fisherman's Horizon

A pacifist settlement on the transcontinental bridge. **Sudden Death** means draws never end, and **Elemental** adds board-space bonuses.
Rules: Elemental, Sudden Death • Trade: Diff • Unlocks: Chapter 7

Trabia

The frozen northern continent. **Plus** rewards mathematical thinking, but **Random** hands make it a gamble.
Rules: Random, Plus • Trade: Diff • Unlocks: Chapter 9

Centra

The ruined southern continent, devastated by the Lunar Cry. **Combo** chains captures from Same and Plus, creating devastating cascades.
Rules: Same, Plus, Combo • Trade: Direct • Unlocks: Chapter 11

Esthar

The technologically advanced hidden nation. **Same Wall** means board edges count as A, **Elemental** adds bonuses, and **Random** removes hand control. The **All** trade rule means total victory or total loss.
Rules: Elemental, Same Wall, Random • Trade: All • Unlocks: Chapter 12

Towns & Dungeons

Towns are safe havens where you can duel NPCs, visit card shops, accept quests, and enter tournaments. **Dungeons** are multi-floor challenges where you face increasingly tough opponents, culminating in a boss fight.

Some locations are **Town-Dungeons** that transform during story events, turning familiar places into dangerous gauntlets.

6. Your Journey

The campaign spans **18 chapters** following a story inspired by Final Fantasy VIII. As you progress, new regions unlock, tougher opponents appear, and the stakes grow higher.

Campaign Overview

CHAPTERS	REGION	CHALLENGE LEVEL
1 – 2	Balamb	Beginner (Level 1–2 cards)
3 – 4	Galbadia	Novice (Level 1–3 cards)
5 – 6	Galbadia	Intermediate (Level 2–3 cards)
7 – 8	FH	Advanced (Level 3–4 cards)
9 – 11	Trabia / Centra	Expert (Level 3–5 cards)
12 – 15	Esthar / Centra	Master (Level 4–6 cards)
16 – 18	Endgame	Legend (Level 5–7+ cards)

Side Quests

Throughout your journey, NPCs will offer **side quests** — special challenges that reward rare cards, cosmetic unlocks, and Gil. Keep an eye out for quest markers above NPC heads.

There are **15 side quests** in total, ranging from finding specific cards to defeating legendary opponents. Completing them all is the mark of a true champion.

SPOILER WARNING

The following pages contain details about the campaign story.
Turn the page only if you wish to learn more.

The Story So Far...

You are a student at **Balamb Garden**, training to become a SeeD — an elite mercenary. But the world of cards runs deeper than anyone suspects. As you travel from the peaceful shores of Balamb to the frozen wastes of Trabia, the ruined continent of Centra, and the hidden techno-nation of Esthar, you will uncover a story of friendship, betrayal, and a threat that spans time itself.

Your journey will take you through fire caverns and prison breaks, across transcontinental bridges and into orbit aboard a lunar base. Along the way, every card match brings you closer to the truth — and to the ultimate opponent.

7. BUILDING YOUR COLLECTION

Card Levels

Cards range from **Level 1** (common creatures) to **Level 10** (legendary heroes). Higher-level cards have stronger stats but are harder to obtain.

Level 1 (Common)

Geezard
1 4 1 5

Funguar
5 1 1 3

Bite Bug
1 3 3 5

Level 5 (Rare)

Iron Giant
6 5 6 5

Behemoth
3 6 5 7

Chimera **[Wat]**
7 6 5 3

Level 10 (Legendary)

Ward Zabac
A 7 2 8

Kiros Seagill
6 7 6 A

Laguna Loire
5 A 3 9

Elements

36 of the 110 cards have an elemental affinity. When the Elemental rule is active, matching a card's element to a board space grants +1 to all stats.

ELEMENT	CARDS
Fire	7 cards
Ice	3 cards
Lightning	7 cards
Earth	7 cards
Water	2 cards
Wind	3 cards
Poison	6 cards
Holy	1 card

Deck Building

Your hand consists of **5 cards** drawn from a deck you build before each match. A good deck balances high-value cards with strategic flexibility:

• Include cards with **strong corners** (high values on two adjacent edges) for board edges
• Keep at least one card with **balanced stats** for the centre position
• In Elemental regions, match your cards' elements to likely board elements
• Against the Random rule, build a **deep collection** so any random hand is decent

Shops

Card shops appear in major towns across every region. Shopkeepers sell card packs at various price points. Higher-level packs cost more Gil but contain stronger cards. Earn Gil by winning duels.

8. Customizing Your Profile

Express yourself with a fully customizable player profile. Your profile card is displayed during multiplayer matches and on leaderboards.

Profile Elements

- **Name** — Choose your player name
- **Icon** — Select from character portraits (30 available)
- **Border** — Frame your profile card (20 styles, 10 unlockable)
- **Background** — Set the card backdrop (27 options, many location-based)
- **Tagline** — A two-part title generated from 100×100 combinations

Unlocking Cosmetics

Many profile options are earned through gameplay:

- **Chapter progress** — Reach specific story chapters
- **Win milestones** — Accumulate total victories
- **Quest completion** — Finish side quests for unique rewards
- **Location visits** — Discover new areas to unlock their backgrounds
- **NPC victories** — Defeat specific opponents for their portrait icons

> TIP
>
> The rarest borders — **Champion**, **Legendary**, and **Conqueror** — are only unlocked by completing the most challenging achievements in the game.

9. Multiplayer

Challenge your friends to Triple Triad matches via **Bluetooth** local multiplayer or **online lobbies**.

Bluetooth (Local)

One player **hosts** a room, advertising via Bluetooth Low Energy. Other nearby players can scan for and join the room. No internet connection required — perfect for playing anywhere.

Online Lobbies

Create or join a lobby via the internet. The host sets the rules, trade rule, and selects two players for the duel. Up to 30 players can join a single lobby as spectators.

Match Flow

1. **Host creates room** and configures rules
2. **Players join** and select their deck
3. **Lock hands** — once both duellists lock in their 5-card hand, they're ready
4. **Host starts the duel**
5. Play proceeds as normal, with the **Friendly** trade rule (no cards exchanged)

10. Settings & Controls

Audio

- **Music** — Toggle the 60-track original soundtrack on/off and adjust volume
- **Sound Effects** — Toggle card placement and capture sounds

Controls

Triple Triad uses intuitive touch controls:

- **Tap a card** in your hand to select it
- **Tap a board space** to place the selected card
- **Swipe** on the world map to navigate between regions and locations

Quick Reference

RULE	SUMMARY
Open	See opponent's hand
Same	Equal touching values → capture
Same Wall	Board edges = A (10)
Plus	Equal touching sums → capture
Combo	Chain captures from Same/Plus
Elemental	Element match +1, mismatch −1
Random	Random hand from deck
Sudden Death	Draws replay with reshuffled hands

TRIPLE TRIAD

"The cards remember what we forget."

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